source filename
Loads and executes the given file, displaying the source lines.

Configuring the Prompt

You have a lot of flexibility in configuring the prompts that irb uses. Sets of prompts are stored in the prompt hash, IRB.conf[:PROMPT].

For example, to establish a new prompt mode called MY_PROMPT, you could enter the following (either directly at an irb prompt or in the .irbrc file):

```
IRB.conf[:PROMPT][:MY_PROMPT] = { # name of prompt mode
  :PROMPT_I => '-->',             # normal prompt
  :PROMPT_S => '--"',             # prompt for continuing strings
  :PROMPT_C => '--+',             # prompt for continuing statement
  :RETURN => "    ==>%s\n"        # format to return value
}
```

Once you've defined a prompt, you have to tell irb to use it. From the command line, you can use the --prompt option. (Notice how the name of the prompt on the command line is automatically converted to uppercase, with hyphens changing to underscores.)

```
$ irb --prompt my-prompt
```

If you want to use this prompt in all your future irb sessions, you can set it as a configuration value in your .irbrc file:

```
IRB.conf[:PROMPT_MODE] = :MY_PROMPT
```

The symbols :PROMPT_I, :PROMPT_N, :PROMPT_S, and :PROMPT_C specify the format for each of the prompt strings. In a format string, certain % sequences are expanded:

Flag	Description
%N	Current command.
%m	to_s of the main object (self).
%M	inspect of the main object (self).
%l	Delimiter type. In strings that are continued across a line break, %l will display the type of delimiter used to begin the string, so you'll know how to end it. The delimiter will be one of ", ', /,], or `.
%NNi	Indent level. The optional number *n* is used as a width specification to printf, as printf("%NNd").
%NNn	Current line number (*n* used as with the indent level).
%%	A literal percent sign.

Table 7—irb prompt string substitutions

The default prompt mode is defined as:

```
IRB.conf[:PROMPT][:DEFAULT] = {
  :PROMPT_I => "%N(%m):%03n:%i> ",
  :PROMPT_N => "%N(%m):%03n:%i> ",
  :PROMPT_S => "%N(%m):%03n:%i%l ",
  :PROMPT_C => "%N(%m):%03n:%i* ",
  :RETURN   => "=> %s\n"
}
```